3 Structuring Layouts

When Rails renders a view as a response, it does so by combining the view with the current layout, using the rules for finding the current layout that were covered earlier in this guide. Within a layout, you have access to three tools for combining different bits of output to form the overall response:

- Asset tags
- `yield` and `content_for`
- Partials

3.1 Asset Tag Helpers

Asset tag helpers provide methods for generating HTML that link views to feeds, JavaScript, stylesheets, images, videos and audios. There are six asset tag helpers available in Rails:

- `auto_discovery_link_tag`
- `javascript_include_tag`
- `stylesheet_link_tag`
- `image_tag`
- `video_tag`
- `audio_tag`

You can use these tags in layouts or other views, although the `auto_discovery_link_tag`, `javascript_include_tag`, and `stylesheet_link_tag`, are most commonly used in the `<head>`section of a layout.

The asset tag helpers do *not* verify the existence of the assets at the specified locations; they simply assume that you know what you're doing and generate the link.

3.1.1 Linking to Feeds with the `auto_discovery_link_tag`

The `auto_discovery_link_tag` helper builds HTML that most browsers and feed readers can use to detect the presence of RSS or Atom feeds. It takes the type of the link (`:rss` or `:atom`), a hash of options that are passed through to url_for, and a hash of options for the tag:

```
<%= auto_discovery_link_tag(:rss, {action: "feed"},
  {title: "RSS Feed"}) %>
```

There are three tag options available for the `auto_discovery_link_tag`:

- `:rel` specifies the `rel` value in the link. The default value is "alternate".
- `:type` specifies an explicit MIME type. Rails will generate an appropriate MIME type automatically.
- `:title` specifies the title of the link. The default value is the uppercase `:type` value, for example, "ATOM" or "RSS".

3.1.2 Linking to JavaScript Files with the `javascript_include_tag`

The `javascript_include_tag` helper returns an HTML `script` tag for each source provided.

If you are using Rails with the Asset Pipeline enabled, this helper will generate a link to `/assets/javascripts/` rather than `public/javascripts` which was used in earlier versions of Rails. This link is then served by the asset pipeline.

A JavaScript file within a Rails application or Rails engine goes in one of three locations: `app/assets`, `lib/assets` or `vendor/assets`. These locations are explained in detail in the Asset Organization section in the Asset Pipeline Guide